

EPAC EDUCATOR KIT

Educator Guide

Audience: Canadian politics, public policy, civics, journalism, and social studies instructors.

epac is a free iOS app that helps students follow Parliament using official public records: Hansard, recorded votes, bills, MP profiles, expenditures, Elections Canada data, Statistics Canada references, and lobbying registry records.

Learning outcomes

- Identify a Member of Parliament and riding using an official source.
- Read Hansard as a primary source.
- Trace a federal bill through parliamentary stages.
- Compare an MP's recorded votes with party, riding, and issue context.
- Cite official parliamentary and government sources in analysis.
- Explain the limits of what government records can and cannot show.

Suggested course uses

One class: Students find their MP, one recent vote, and one recent speech, then compare whether the vote and speech address the same policy area.

Two weeks: Assign "Track Your MP for 30 Days." Students collect a speech, a recorded vote, and either an expense disclosure or bill interaction.

Semester: Students maintain a weekly source log for a riding or topic.

Classroom workflow

1. Ask students to install epac or pair with a classmate who can access iOS.
2. Review key terms on the FAQ page at epac.riddimsoftware.com/faq.html.
3. Have students identify a riding and MP.
4. Require source links for each factual claim.
5. Grade the evidence trail, not political agreement.

Assessment rubric

Criterion	Strong	Developing	Needs work
Source trail	Every factual claim points to an official record.	Most claims are sourced.	Claims rely on unsourced summaries.

Institutional understanding	Correctly explains MP, party, bill, vote, and riding roles.	Minor terminology errors.	Confuses institutions or procedures.
Analysis	Connects evidence to a clear civic question.	Describes records with limited synthesis.	Broad claims unsupported by records.
Neutrality	Uses precise, non-partisan language.	Some loaded language.	Advocacy replaces analysis.

Instructor checklist

- Confirm the assignment fits course privacy and accessibility policy.
- Provide a non-iOS alternative for students who need it.
- Require source links or screenshots of official records.
- Remind students that epac is independent and not affiliated with government.